

automates the provisioning management and scaling of the application, while the self-administering, self-tuning, self-healing and synchronisation support features of SAP SQL Anywhere make it well-suited for zero-administration environments.

Ubuntu MATE 14.04.1 LTS released

Ubuntu has released the 14.04.1 LTS version of its MATE desktop distribution. Ubuntu has been providing support for the LTS versions of its distributions for many years. The Ubuntu developers' team follows a fixed release cycle. According to the cycle, 14.04 LTS should have been released in April 2014, but the developers missed the deadline. So, Ubuntu released MATE 14.10 as per schedule in October



this year. The version number might confuse users and look older to them but MATE 14.04.1 LTS is much improved compared to MATE 14.10. Ubuntu developers have integrated many new features in 14.04.1 LTS. This new distro comes with indicators support, new panel layout, improved

accessibility features and the latest Orca 3.14. The UI of MATE 14.04.1 LTS is much more polished than 14.10. Lots of new Debian packages have been added. A lot of users have been seen adopting the Ubuntu MATE distro this year. With the new LTS version, Ubuntu users can stick to the distro for a long time and not worry about updates. Ubuntu has pushed most of these changes to MATE 14.10 via updates. Ubuntu developers will support Ubuntu MATE 14.04 LTS till 2019. Users need not worry about security fixes and important updates till 2019.

Halcyon Software introduces a monitoring solution for Linux

Halcyon Software has announced the immediate availability of Network Server Suite's new component, the Linux on Power agent, which runs on IBM Power Systems. This new agent will ensure that companies have tighter control over key business processes and 'mission-critical' applications running on Linux, through continuous monitoring and automatic management. Halcyon's new monitoring technology meets the requirements of organisations deploying Linux on IBM Power Systems to give greater scalability, reducing 'server sprawl' and infrastructure costs, particularly for large data centres and managed service providers (MSPs) with cloud-based offerings. The new Linux on Power agent enhances Halcyon's Network Server Suite, which already includes a Linux on Intel agent, as an optional plugin module. Network Server Suite is a leading monitoring and automation solution that supports Windows, AIX and Linux operating systems. It ensures maximum availability of critical servers, applications, processes, services and network devices to maintain business operations around the clock.

QueueMetrics Asterisk call-centre monitor version 14.10 is out

QueueMetrics version 14.10 is centred around three main themes – improving usability by implementing a series of suggestions that came as feedback on the Icon page, incorporating a number of changes that make the experience generally smoother, and improving deployability by leveraging and extending the new JSON API. This version also has a command-line updater tool and a new HTTP-only data loader that does not require a direct connection to the QueueMetrics database. This makes deploying large numbers of cloud QueueMetrics instances easier. Plus, a number of configuration defaults have been updated and the sample

Canonical may stop producing 32-bit Ubuntu by 2016

Canonical has no immediate plans of dropping the development of 32-bit Ubuntu ISOs. On being asked about when 32-bit images would stop being made, company spokespersons said there were no plans for it as of now, but these could be dropped after the release of Ubuntu 16.04. Ubuntu 16.04 LTS is supposed to be released in 2016, which should be the last 32-bit release of Ubuntu distro. There is a lot of ground work that Ubuntu developers need to do in order to push people to adopt 64-bit Ubuntu. They need to investigate 32-bit EFI issues and push the 64-bit Linux kernel to 32-bit Ubuntu users on x86_64 systems. Ubuntu developers have started to push people to adopt 64-bit compatible hardware. Last year, Ubuntu started recommending the 64-bit version of Ubuntu as default to users. The latest Ubuntu 14.10 64-bit has a way better benchmark score than the 32-bit version.

New kernel live patching solution out

SUSE launched its live kernel patching software, called kGraft, in February. Red Hat released kPatch in April. Even though the news created a big buzz amongst users, both have not been accepted at the upstream level yet. Now, a new live kernel patching solution based on ftrace mechanism is out. This is a combination of the best functionality in kpatch and kGraft. It uses the kernel interface with the kernel module function for live patching. This solution was released at a live patching mini conference at the Linux Plumbers Conference, which happened recently. The new live kernel patching mechanism can be found in the patch series released last month. Developers will be able to test it out when Linux kernel v3.19 is out.